

Table 11.7 :Number of Housing Units and Status of Housing Units, by Sector and District, 2024

Sector/District	Housing units		Status of housing units							
	Total	%	Permanent	%	Semi-permanent	%	Improved	%	Not classified	%
Sri Lanka	6,030,541	100.0	5,802,099	96.2	212,758	3.5	11,146	0.2	4,538	0.1
Sector										
Urban*	1,028,363	100.0	1,010,342	98.2	16,668	1.6	734	0.1	619	0.1
Rural	4,773,336	100.0	4,596,479	96.3	163,297	3.4	10,153	0.2	3,407	0.1
Estate-Rural**	228,842	100.0	195,278	85.4	32,793	14.3	259	0.1	512	0.2
District										
Colombo	654,051	100.0	645,260	98.6	8,256	1.3	195	0.0	340	0.1
Gampaha	683,025	100.0	673,967	98.7	8,381	1.2	404	0.1	273	0.0
Kalutara	349,430	100.0	341,868	97.9	7,237	2.1	156	0.0	169	0.0
Kandy	389,826	100.0	369,080	94.7	20,395	5.2	216	0.1	135	0.0
Matale	148,184	100.0	139,556	94.2	8,492	5.7	75	0.1	61	0.0
Nuwara Eliya	192,915	100.0	179,664	93.1	12,472	6.5	344	0.2	435	0.2
Galle	305,379	100.0	298,982	98.0	6,129	2.0	138	0.0	130	0.0
Matara	230,034	100.0	223,653	97.3	6,193	2.7	113	0.0	75	0.0
Hambantota	187,558	100.0	183,050	97.7	4,364	2.3	84	0.0	60	0.0
Jaffna	156,797	100.0	151,345	96.5	4,360	2.8	681	0.4	411	0.3
Mannar	32,005	100.0	30,767	96.1	721	2.3	448	1.4	69	0.2
Vavuniya	47,825	100.0	45,540	95.3	2,118	4.4	109	0.2	58	0.1
Mullaitivu	34,348	100.0	32,391	94.3	1,636	4.8	247	0.7	74	0.2
Kilinochchi	36,484	100.0	34,320	94.2	1,684	4.6	315	0.9	165	0.5
Batticaloa	167,150	100.0	155,172	92.8	9,628	5.8	1,967	1.2	383	0.2
Ampara	202,861	100.0	194,136	95.7	8,112	4.0	417	0.2	196	0.1
Trincomalee	119,351	100.0	113,999	95.6	4,580	3.8	537	0.4	235	0.2
Kurunegala	506,909	100.0	490,386	96.8	15,815	3.1	468	0.1	240	0.0
Puttalam	231,494	100.0	219,032	94.6	8,778	3.8	3,485	1.5	199	0.1
Anuradhapura	271,408	100.0	261,751	96.4	9,432	3.5	138	0.1	87	0.0
Polonnaruwa	126,482	100.0	122,315	96.8	4,071	3.2	54	0.0	42	0.0
Badulla	239,417	100.0	223,698	93.4	15,445	6.5	36	0.0	238	0.1
Moneragala	150,728	100.0	139,342	92.4	11,152	7.4	106	0.1	128	0.1
Ratnapura	324,853	100.0	303,654	93.4	20,802	6.4	218	0.1	179	0.1
Kegalle	242,027	100.0	229,171	94.6	12,505	5.2	195	0.1	156	0.1

*Although the 2024 Census collected information separately as urban and estate urban, here the two categories are combined and shown as urban.

** The sector identified as 'Estate' in the 2012 Census corresponds to the 'Estate Rural' category in the 2024 Census.

According to Table 11.7, the highest proportion of housing units in Sri Lanka consists of permanent housing units, accounting for 96.2 percent. When examined by sector, the estate rural sector records the highest share of semi-permanent housing units at 14.3 percent. At the district level, the highest proportion of semi-permanent housing is reported in Moneragala district (7.4%). Relatively higher percentages are also observed in Badulla district (6.5%) and Nuwara Eliya district (6.5%). Furthermore, the highest percentage of housing units classified as improvised is reported in Puttalam district (1.5%).